Income idea. None of your senior leaders actively promoted it. I found it disappointing. I believed the UPA could have won in 2019 based on this.

RG: You're right! We couldn't go all out with NYAY at that time, but we will. By the way, many in the Congress didn't even believe in the NREGA initially. Only we believed in it, and it was implemented.

SR: Rahul, I would like to see NYAY as the major platform on which the UPA campaigns in 2024.

RG: I fully agree with you. It's already beginning to be implemented in states where we have governments.

Our conversation then traversed into India's complex agrarian crisis, the necessity for a guaranteed Minimum Support Price, the farmers' protest and related issues. Then Rahul asked, 'By the way, what's your take on agriculture in China? How does it compare to India?' This question triggered a discussion on the urgent need to reshape India's agricultural priorities, emphasizing the protection of ecosystems while simultaneously improving farmers' yields and incomes. We also delved into the potentially disastrous impact of Kerala's high-speed rail project, labelling it as an economic and ecological catastrophe of unprecedented proportions.

People's Embrace of the Bharat Jodo Yatra

The BJY was a transformative experience that struck a deep chord with the masses. Unlike the typical pre-election ritual of politicians traversing long distances in vehicles, the BJY had a different essence. Crowds spontaneously gathered along the Yatra's route at all hours, drawn by a shared sentiment. This Yatra was not about election campaigns or a one-man show—it was about uniting India and confronting divisive forces. People from diverse age groups and ideologies were captivated by its message.